

Brian N. White

bnw@unc.edu briannathanwhite.github.io github linkedin

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Statistics & Operations Research

Expected May 2026

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Dissertation: *Scalable Spatial Extreme Value Data Fusion with Applications to Coastal Hazard Projection Under a Changing Climate*.

Advisor: Richard Smith.

M.A., Mathematical Statistics

2020

Wake Forest University · Full scholarship with stipend

B.A., Environmental Studies (Ecology)

2018

University of North Carolina at Asheville

EXPERIENCE

Biostatistician III

2022 – Present

Wake Forest School of Medicine, Dept. of Biostatistics & Data Science

Opioid misuse surveillance: implementing and contributing to the development of Bayesian models that integrate fragmented data sources across spatial and temporal scales to estimate the size of hidden populations, and working with state health departments to turn these estimates into operational tools. Supported by NIDA R01DA052214 (MPIs: Kline, Hepler). NIH LEAP trial: contributing statistician for anti-obesity medication RCT. Clinical collaboration across surgery, pediatrics, gerontology, and gastroenterology. Causal inference on observational EHR data.

Graduate Research Assistant

2020 – Present

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Forecasting extreme coastal water levels across climate scenarios by fusing physics-based ocean simulations with historical tide gauge observations via scalable Gaussian processes.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2018 – Present

UNC Chapel Hill & Wake Forest University

Machine Learning, Statistical Modeling, Biostatistics, Data Analysis, Discrete Mathematics, Regression.

SKILLS

Foundations: Measure-theoretic probability, asymptotic theory, stochastic processes, optimization, real and functional analysis

Methods: Bayesian hierarchical modeling, MCMC, spatial/spatiotemporal statistics, extreme value theory, Gaussian processes, causal inference, experimental design, survival analysis, mixed models

Computing: Python, R, PyTorch, Stan, JAGS, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Git, Linux, HPC/Slurm

PUBLICATIONS

1. **White**, Blanton, Luettich, Smith. Fusing sparse observations and dense simulations for spatial extreme value analysis: Application to U.S. coastal sea levels. *arXiv preprint*, 2026. arXiv · code
2. **White**, Blanton, Luettich, Smith. Scalable fusion of heterogeneous extreme value data via Vecchia-approximated Gaussian processes with application to climate-conditioned storm surge projections. *In preparation*.
3. Young, Rives, Gudzone, Jaeger, Simmons, **White**, et al. The long-term effectiveness of the anti-obesity medication phentermine (LEAP) trial: Rationale, design, and baseline characteristics. *Contemporary Clinical Trials*, 2026.
4. Jeong, Edmunds, McCollum, **White**, Clayton. Lower mean nocturnal baseline impedance in erosive reflux disease, Barrett’s Esophagus, and elevated body mass index compared to nonerosive reflux disease. *Diseases of the Esophagus*, 2026.
5. Kline, **White**, Lancaster, et al. Estimating prevalence of opioid misuse in North Carolina counties from 2016–2021: An integrated abundance model approach. *Epidemiology*, 2025.
6. Lippert, Callahan, **White**, et al. Hospitalist and “SNFist” clinician perspectives on frailty assessment of rehab patients. *Journal of General Internal Medicine*, 2025.
7. Semelka, **White**, Callahan, Pajewski. The association of frailty with post-hospital discharge location and health outcomes. *Journal of the American Geriatrics Society*, 2025.

8. Heeren, Ruddiman, Simmons, **White**, et al. Application of the Lancet Commission criteria for the diagnosis of obesity to a clinical trials population: The LEAP trial. *Obesity*, 2025.
9. Krakovski, Madigan, Cecil, **White**, et al. Patient factors contributing to wireless pH monitoring intolerance. *Journal of Clinical Gastroenterology*, 2025.
10. Brown, **White**, Hanchate, et al. Short term health outcomes of the Weaver fertilizer plant fire on the surrounding community. *Journal of Public Health Management & Practice*, 2025.
11. Estadt, **White**, Ricks, et al. The impact of fentanyl on state- and county-level psychostimulant and cocaine overdose death rates by race in Ohio from 2010 to 2020: A time series and spatiotemporal analysis. *Harm Reduction Journal*, 2024.
12. Khanna, Banga, Rigdon, **White**, et al. Role of continuous pulse oximetry and capnography monitoring in the prevention of postoperative respiratory failure, postoperative opioid-induced respiratory depression and adverse outcomes on hospital wards: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *Journal of Clinical Anesthesia*, 2024.
13. Kipp, Vesely, Lance, **White**, et al. Age influence on total ankle arthroplasty outcomes: A systematic review. *Journal of Foot and Ankle Surgery*, 2024.
14. Vesely, Kipp, Lance, **White**, et al. BMI influence on total ankle arthroplasty outcomes: A systematic review. *Foot & Ankle Surgery: Techniques, Reports & Cases*, 2024.
15. Fabian, Adkins, **White**, et al. Temporal trends in BAHA softband wear time among pediatric patients. *International Journal of Pediatric Otorhinolaryngology*, 2024.

PRESENTATIONS

White, Hepler, Hu, Jetson, Xiong, Smith, Delcher, Kline. Estimation of the prevalence of opioid misuse in Washington State counties, 2017–2023: A Bayesian spatiotemporal abundance model approach. Wake Forest Public Health Staff Science Day, 2025. Poster & Ignite talk (selected from ~100 applicants).

White, Blanton, Luettich, Smith. Combining observational and model data for spatial extremes through a multivariate Gaussian latent process. 14th International Conference on Extreme Value Analysis (EVA 2025). Poster.

Classical piano background (Shepherd School of Music, Rice). Student of the Taubman approach.